

Limited-Sources Justification (LSJ)

Content Prepared IAW FAR 8.405-6 (b) and 8.405-6(c)(2)

Approved at the Prescribed Levels IAW FAR 8.405-6(d)(3)

This acquisition is made pursuant to the authority of Multiple Award Schedule Program, 41 U.S.C. 152(3), and FAR 8.405-6(a).

(1) Identification of the agency and the contracting activity, and specific identification of the document as a "Limited-Sources Justification." IAW FAR 8.405-6(c)(2)(i)

Contracting Activity is the General Services Administration (GSA), Federal Acquisition Service (FAS), Supply Chain Management (SCM) Contracting Division, Office of Contract Operations, General Supplies and Services (GSS) (QSCC). This is a Limited-Sources Justification (LSJ) completed on behalf of the various requiring activities that order Part Number (PN) items on contract solutions maintained by GSA Global Supply.

(2) Nature and/or description of the action being approved. IAW FAR 8.405-6(c)(2)(ii)

The action being approved is the procurement of pre-competed, contracted Brand Name PN items with order values between the Micro Purchase Threshold (MPT) but not to exceed the Simplified Acquisition Threshold (SAT).

(3) A description of the supplies or services required to meet the agency's needs (including the estimated value). IAW FAR 8.405-6(c)(2)(iii)

The items required include PNs of various commodity types.

The PNs are competed and contracted for on requisition-channel-specific¹ Blanket Purchase Agreements (BPAs) awarded against various Multiple Award Schedule contracts. These BPAs include the following:

- Requisition Channel IT BPA
- MRO Requisition Channel, Generation Two (RC2)
- Janitorial and Sanitation Requisition BPA (JanSan2)
- Office Supplies Requisition Channel BPA, Generation Four (OS4)
- Office Supplies Requisition Channel BPA, Generation Five (OS5)²

The estimated value (see Attachment 1: IGCE) of the portion of these vehicles to which the justification applies is \$3.95 million for one year. This amount does not extend the estimated value of the original procurements. This amount falls within the original scope and dollar value of the competed BPAs.

¹ These 'requisition channel' solutions are designed to handle gov-to-gov transactions (transactions where billing is accomplished via interfund transfer), between DOD and some federal customers and GSA. This is in contrast to 'purchasing channel' solutions, where the financial component is handled directly between the agency customer and the vendor (such as government purchase card buys, for example). The distinction is important for the justification because oftentimes the requisition infrastructure that makes gov-to-gov transactions possible is the same infrastructure that presents functional barriers (such as lack of POC information) to obtaining brand name justifications from customers at an individual requisition level.

² Currently being solicited; not yet awarded.

The order processing method proposed in this justification will be put in place on a pilot basis for one year, after which the pilot will be re-assessed before renewing or extending the method. If the conditions that required this justification (market dynamics, GSA and customer system constraints, customer requirements, etc) remain unchanged, another LSJ will be prepared at that time before extending the use of this method.

(4) The authority and supporting rationale and, if applicable, a demonstration of the proposed contractor's unique qualifications to provide the required supply or service. IAW FAR 8.405-6(c)(2)(iv)

Authority

The authority at FAR [8.405-6\(a\)\(1\)\(i\)\(B\)](#) is hereby cited: "Only one source³ is capable of providing the supplies or services required at the level of quality required because the supplies or services are unique or highly specialized." Part numbers by their very nature are described in terms of 'brand names', such as the name of the Manufacturer and the Manufacturer PN, and therefore the requirement is inherently limited to providers of those brand name items.

Supporting Rationale

- Market research for the PNs required is conducted by requiring activities to find acceptable solutions for their supply needs before the requisition is processed under these BPAs
- The items required for the end user's need have been deemed as peculiar to one or more manufacturers (ie, a specific brand name(s)) and are not feasible to express in terms of salient characteristics
- Changing the item to a different make or model would result in inferior performance and/or incompatibility with existing systems or tools and would compromise the agency personnel's ability to fulfill their mission
- Requiring the creation of salient characteristics for the purpose of soliciting the items on a non-brand name basis has shown to be prohibitively time-consuming, delaying the fulfillment of the customer's mission and disrupting their continuity of operations. The current method has resulted in 24.7% of the requisitions being canceled due to:
 - Customer inability to provide a justification or salient characteristics
 - Customer non-responsiveness to repeated attempts to obtain a justification or salient characteristics; or
 - Lack of valid customer POC information

These poor results are not surprising given the functional workflow of how our contracts are established and how our customers order supplies. This is laid out in the Rational Workflow diagram provided as Attachment 2.

³The term 'one source' is understood to be synonymous with a Brand Name requirement. This is not to say that only one source, i.e. vendor, is capable of providing the supplies; to the contrary, many vendors or sources are typically able to provide the brand name items required, and in fact the supplies to which this justification will apply have been solicited to, and received quotations from, a large number of sources prior to establishment of these BPAs.

- Army, Navy, and other DOD components' ordering systems often fail to transmit email addresses or other contact information, or the contact information provided is for personnel unrelated to the requiring activity, leaving acquisition staff unable to obtain salient information from a valid point of contact
- Salient characteristic information is in many cases proprietary. Obtaining information about item features like metal composition or treatment methods, manufacturing tolerances or processes, or design schematics or CAD drawings and then publicizing those in a solicitation could compromise the trade secret(s) of the Original Equipment Manufacturer (OEM), opening the government to litigation risk.
- Since the government often lacks access to salient characteristics or has access only to limited or partial salient characteristics of the brand name items required, "equal" products can't be reliably assessed. Mandating that the customer produce this salient characteristic information does not typically yield adequate results, as the customer will only have access to information made publicly available by the OEM, which is either limited or nonexistent in many cases. Competing on an 'or equal' basis using such limited salient characteristic information produced by non-technical end users (supply or ordering officers) exposes both the agency and the item end users to the risk of inadequate, noncompliant, and in some cases potentially dangerous products.
- The estimated cost-per-requisition to the agency and ultimately to the taxpayer caused by the dysfunctional methodology currently in place is summarized in the chart below. The Action descriptions condense the past few years' CO experience with this method into a 'typical' scenario and the Labor time is an estimate of how much working time is required to address at each Action step:

Action	Labor time (mins)
finding POC information, sending first email to customer	10
second email to customer	3
third email to customer	3
total email time	16
customer required explanation of requirement - CO drafts and sends explanation reply	30
customer rebuts explanation, requests further explanation or demands different method - CO reiterates current FAR requirement/interpretation yet also reclarifies that any acceptable alternative will have final authority from customer to accept	30
customer accepts explanations and agrees to provide salients or a brand name justification, yet list of salients or BNJ is delivered after another 5 days. The initial draft is poor and inadequate to substantiate a meaningful competition. CO or CS proposes edits or proceeds to draft salients or BNJ on customer's behalf despite lacking authoritative knowledge of customer technical requirements; provides to customer for sign-off/approval.	60

Labor time, in minutes, per requisition	136
Labor time, in hours, per requisition	2.3
Fully Burdened Government FTE rate (per hour)	\$261.39
Cost per requisition (FTE rate * hours)	\$592.48
Total count of requisitions/yr, across all four solutions	166
Total annual cost	\$98,352.34

Allowing the first pass method proposed in this justification will save an estimated \$98,352 per year expended by the Government to continue carrying on with this friction-filled process that adds zero value for GSA, its customers, or the taxpayers.

(5) A determination by the ordering activity contracting officer that the order represents the best value consistent with 8.404(d). IAW FAR 8.405-6(c)(2)(v)

Quotes for the PNs ordered have been fully competed – at their full expected aggregate value over the the life of the BPA – and evaluated on a Lowest Price Technically Acceptable (LPTA) basis before being placed on the BPAs, and all of the items must be awarded and on the offeror's MAS contract, and thus have previously been determined fair and reasonable by the MAS CO, in accordance with FAR 8.404(d).

First-pass processing of PN orders above MPT (but below SAT) will significantly improve the average delivery time, efficiency of the supply chain, and mission fulfillment for civilian and DOD customers alike.

The CO finds that the contemplated contracting action supported by this document represents the best value consistent with FAR 8.404(d).

(6) A description of the market research conducted among schedule holders and the results or a statement of the reason market research was not conducted. IAW FAR 8.405-6(c)(2)(vi)

Market research for the Brand Name requirements was conducted by the requiring activity prior to placing the order.

Market research was also conducted by the contracting activity prior to solicitation of the requirement and award of the BPAs using requests for information (RFI) from industry.

The results of these market research activities found that the most efficient means of meeting the government's requirements is through the use of item descriptions peculiar to one brand or manufacturer.

(7) Any other facts supporting the justification. IAW FAR 8.405-6(c)(2)(vii)

The increase of the order value from the MPT to the SAT allowed to process 'first pass' for the PN items on the BPAs identified above directly align with GSA's founding mission and is reinforced by current initiatives to maximize efficiency and ensure the best use of taxpayer

dollars⁴. The additional burden and administrative costs associated with procuring each requirement over the MPT as a separate individual order is wasteful, inefficient, and overly burdensome on the acquisition workforce. In addition, it delays the ability of GSA to meet the mission-critical needs of the customers for which it serves, in particular the DoD, which relies on GSA for timely provision of mission-essential needs.

Impact on Competition (to include small business):

There are no changes to the base PN requirements nor the estimated dollar value of the original competitive procurements. Therefore, the actions proposed in this LSJ have no impact on the number of vendors who would have qualified or the number of vendors responding to the initial RFQ.

8) A statement of the actions, if any, the agency may take to remove or overcome any barriers that led to the restricted consideration before any subsequent acquisition for the supplies or services is made. IAW FAR 8.405-6(c)(2)(viii)

The contracting activity is already balancing maximizing the level of competition received with the functional aspects of delivering for our customers in an efficient and timely manner. Since the award of these vehicles, the need for these PN items has continued. The competitors in these markets are numerous and sufficient for strong competition at the BPA level. Furthermore, in those cases where multiple BPA vendors quoted the same item, only the lowest price item was allowed to be sold (i.e., added to the BPA).

The set of vendors who competed for and won the resultant BPAs are by definition the same vendors who would compete for individually sourced orders that are only being competed in such a way due to their dollar value exceeding the MPT. Much operational efficiency is lost by repeating or essentially recompeting these purchases over and over again rather than allowing for their processing against already existent and fully competed BPAs and is consistent with the "survey three" method prescribed at [FAR 8.405-1\(c\)\(1\)](#), wherein no mention is made of obtaining either a BN justification or a list of salient characteristics from the customer before proceeding with a determination of best value, at order levels from MPT up to SAT.

Processing MPT+ contract PN orders in this fashion ('first pass') saves time, drives efficiency, and ensures customer missions are met while saving taxpayer money.

(9) The ordering activity contracting officer's certification that the justification is accurate and complete to the best of the contracting officer's knowledge and belief. IAW FAR 8.405-6(c)(2)(ix)

I certify that the facts and representations included in this justification and approved for other than full and open competition are complete and accurate to the best of my knowledge.

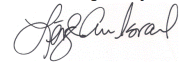
(10) Evidence that any supporting data that is the responsibility of technical or requirements personnel (e.g., verifying the Government's minimum needs or requirements or other rationale for limited sources) and which form a basis for the justification have been certified as complete and accurate by the technical or requirements personnel. IAW FAR 8.405-6(c)(2)(x)

4

<https://www.whitehouse.gov/presidential-actions/2025/03/eliminating-waste-and-saving-taxpayer-dollars-by-consolidating-procurement/>

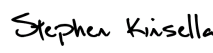
n/a

(11) For justifications under 8.405-6(a)(1), a written determination by the approving official identifying the circumstance that applies. IAW FAR 8.405-6(c)(2)(xi)

DocuSigned by:

8DE074FA4C094D7...

4/16/2025

Leigh Ann Israel - QSCCC
SCM Contracting Division, Contracting Officer

DocuSigned by:

7534C0E11643431...

4/16/2025

Stephen Kinsella - QSCCC
SCM Contracting Division, Tools & Hardware, Branch Chief

DocuSigned by:

A8CDCC942F2A4B9...

4/16/2025

Robert Woodside - QSCC
SCM Contracting Division, Division Director

DocuSigned by:

CD0B0ABF5DF64F6...

4/16/2025

Theresa Ramos - QSA
Competition Advocate

Signed by:

8EC5101824AA406

4/16/2025

Jeff Thurston - QSC
Contracting Executive

DocuSigned by:

8F31F54AC2F8491...

4/16/2025

Erville Koehler - QS
Head of the Contracting Activity

[Attachment 1: Independent Government Cost Estimate \(IGCE\)](#)

[Attachment 2: Rational Workflow](#)